



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Assessing the Requirements and Goals That Your Organization Has



Learning Outcome:

Understand information about people's backgrounds in spoken or written documents.

Define strategies to make terms of reference and supplier assessment processes, in technology acquisition, based on established protocols.

Ask your partner:

- How important do you think it is to prioritize an organization's needs in order to choose an IT product? Why?
- What common risks do you think a negotiator might have to take into account?

Can Do Statements:

- I can discuss the importance of assessment when dealing with technology contracts.
- I can talk about requests for proposals (RFP).
- I can manage other basic terms to manage risks with technology contractors.



Let's Explore!

Risks in Technology Negotiations



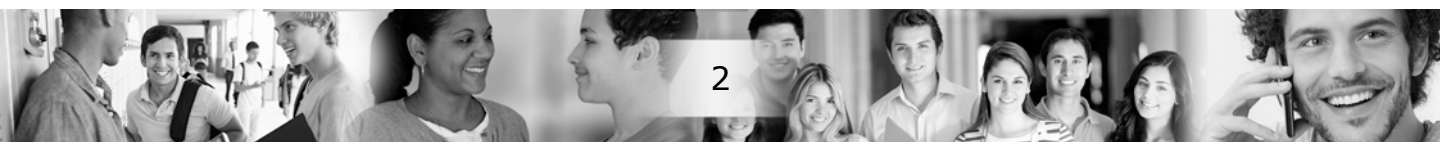
Request for Proposals

Instructions: Read the text below.

Procuring the right IT product is often a key element in a company's success. However, not taking the time you need to properly negotiate inadvisable vendor contracts is sometimes a faulty business procedure. In order not to face legal pitfalls when dealing with technology contracts, take into consideration the following tips.

Before getting into any negotiation, assess the requirements and goals that your organization has, and define what the project scope, duration, and budget are. By doing so, you can have a bigger picture of the real systems requirements that your organization needs. Not assessing carefully the system requirements to achieve those goals can lead to additional costs. Once you have identified your needs, you can then issue a request for proposals (RFP), which will allow you to evaluate the best technology systems bid that fits your organization's needs. Through an RFP, technology vendors will submit proposals based on your specific needs and capabilities. You also need to make sure not to skimp on due diligence. Analyze each proposal deeply. Not double-checking references, past performances and industry reputation can affect negatively your project. Consider not choosing just one final vendor, but the best two in order to have a better chance to get a more beneficial outcome from the negotiations.

Finally, try not to accept any boilerplate contracts. Quite too often, technology vendor proposals include contracts that are always the same, and focus more on protecting the vendor's interests instead of yours. Demand to have a proposal that is tailored to your company's needs and make sure the rights and obligations stated in the contract are equally balanced for both parties. If a vendor insists on not changing the contract, it is time to consider other vendors.





Let's Practice!

What to Do and What Not to Do With RFP

Instructions: Classify the sentences by writing the number of the sentence in the correct category.

1. It helps you evaluate the best technology systems bid that fits your organization's needs.
2. It is helpful to use RFP for submitting proposals based on your specific needs and capabilities.
3. It is not favorable to receive only one proposal; you need to make a request for proposals.
4. It's not good to make a simple RFP; you need to be as detailed as possible.
5. You need to make sure to talk about capabilities and functionality; it is not useful to receive proposals that are not up to the game.

What NOT to Do With RFP	What RFP Allows You to Do



Let's Practice!

Assessing Technology Contracts

Instructions: Organized the mystery sentence.

1. requirements / Not / system / additional / costs. / can / lead / assessing / to / the / carefully
2. references / negatively / affect / double-checking / project. / your / can / Not
3. procedure. / inadvisable / to / vendor / faulty / contracts / a / negotiate / business / properly / taking / the / Not / time / is
4. your / requirements / organization / define / has, / and / the / that / Assess / project / scopes. / the / what
5. organization. / allow / best / bid / systems / the / your / fits / evaluate / that / Needs / to / technology / you



Extension Activity

My Company's RFP

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Review what a RFP is.
- Create a RFP document for the company you work or would like to work for.
- Present your document to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

- I review information about RFP
- I make a RFP document for my company.
- I present my document to a partner.

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Target Words

- **a key element** (expression): an important or essential part.
e.g. Procuring the right IT product is often a key element in a company's success.
- **inadvisable** (adjective): related to something that might have unwanted results, so it is not recommended.
e.g. However, not taking the time you need to properly negotiate inadvisable vendor contracts is sometimes a faulty business procedure.
- **a bigger picture** (expression): a better understanding of a situation.
e.g. By doing so, you can have a bigger picture of the real systems requirements that your organization needs.
- **bid** (noun): an offer.
e.g. Once you have identified your needs, you can then issue a request for proposals (RFP), which will allow you to evaluate the best technology systems bid that fits your organization's needs .
- **due diligence** (expression): a detailed assessment and examination of a situation.
e.g. You also need to make sure not to skimp on due diligence.
- **boilerplate** (noun): a legal text that is standardized; not special, without changes.
e.g. Finally, try not to accept any boilerplate contracts.



Learning Points

Verb + Ing - Position of Not

The gerund, which is the **-ing** form of a verb, can be used as the subject of a sentence.

Gerunds can be used as regular nouns. The **gerund** is a word that ends in **-ing** that is made from a verb.

The gerund can be used as the subject of a sentence.

Take a look at the following example:

- **Issuing** an RFP allows a company to get better IT deals.

They can be affirmative or **negative**. To make the negative form, place **not** before the **-ing** subject:

- **Not assessing** the company's needs may lead to an unsuccessful IT implementation.

Examples

- *However, not taking the time you need to properly negotiate inadvisable vendor contracts is sometimes a faulty business procedure.*
- *Not assessing carefully the system requirements to achieve those goals can lead to additional costs.*

To + Verb - Position of Not

Some verbs are followed specifically by **-ing** or **infinitive forms** of the verbs.

The following is a list of common verbs that are followed by the **infinitive form** of the verb:

• Decide • Need • Choose • Determine • Want • Try	to verb
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The negative infinitive is made by placing **not** before the **to infinitive**.

verb + NOT + to infinitive

For example:

Try not to ignore the company's IT expectations in order to get a better outcome of an IT implementation.

Examples

- *Finally, try not to accept any boilerplate contracts.*
- *You also need to make sure not to skimp on the due diligence.*

